

Basics

Fundamental SQL Interview Questions with Answers



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1

What is the difference between SQL and MySQL?

SQL is a standard language for managing relational databases

MySQL is a specific database management system that uses SQL as its querying language.



2

In what order does SQL execute different clauses such as SELECT, WHERE, GROUP BY etc.?

**SQL executes clauses in this order:
FROM, WHERE, GROUP BY, HAVING, SELECT,
ORDER BY.**



3

Difference between DROP and TRUNCATE

DROP: Removes the entire table definition and data (permanent).

TRUNCATE: Deletes all data from the table, but keeps the table structure.



4

What is Alias in SQL?

Alias is a temporary name for a table or column.

Example: `SELECT customer_name AS name`



What are the constraints in SQL?

Constraints are used to specify rules for the data in a table.

Common constraints:

- NOT NULL
- UNIQUE
- PRIMARY KEY
- FOREIGN KEY
- CHECK



6

What is DDL (Data Definition Language)

It is used to define the structure of the database

Examples: CREATE, ALTER , DROP.



What is DML (Data Manipulation Language)

It is used to manipulate data within the database

Examples: SELECT, INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE.



Difference between DELETE and TRUNCATE

DELETE: Removes specific rows from a table.

TRUNCATE: Deletes all rows from a table.



Difference between **DISTINCT** and **GROUP BY**

DISTINCT: Retrieves unique values

GROUP BY: Groups data based on a common value in a specified column.



10

Difference between WHERE and HAVING

WHERE: Filters rows before grouping
(applies to individual rows).

HAVING: Filters grouped data after grouping
(applies to aggregated results)

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